

Activity Guide: Getting Started with Git

This guide will walk you through installing Git, cloning a repository, making changes, and pushing your work back to the cloud.

Prerequisites: Before you begin, ensure you have a stable internet connection and a GitHub account (or an account on the cloud platform used by your instructor).

Step 1: Install Git on Your Computer

To run Git commands, you first need to install the software using the Windows Package Manager (*winget*).

1. Press the **Windows Key**, type **cmd**, and press **Enter** to open the Command Prompt.
2. Copy and paste the following command, then press **Enter**:

```
winget install Git.Git
```

3. **Important:** Once the installation finishes, **close the Command Prompt window and open a new one** to activate Git.

Step 2: Clone the Project Repository

Cloning creates a local copy of the cloud project on your computer.

1. In your Command Prompt, navigate to the folder where you want to save your project (e.g., type **cd Documents** and press Enter).
2. Type the following command (replace *gitlink_goes_here* with the actual URL provided by your instructor) and press **Enter**:

```
git clone gitlink_goes_here
```

3. Move into the newly created project folder by typing:

```
cd name-of-your-cloned-folder
```

Step 3: Make Changes to a File

1. Open the project folder using a text editor (like Notepad or VS Code).
2. Open the file you want to edit, make your changes (e.g., editing your website text), and **save the file**.

Step 4: Stage and Commit Your Changes

Before saving your changes to Git's history, you must introduce yourself to the system.

1. **Stage your changes** (this prepares all modified files to be saved):

```
git add .
```

2. **Save your changes** with a descriptive message:

```
git commit -m "Updated my website"
```

First-Time Setup Configuration:

If the system stops you and asks, *"Tell me who you are,"* you need to configure your identity. Run these two commands using your actual email and name:

```
git config --global user.email "your-github-email@example.com"
```

```
git config --global user.name "Your Real Name"
```

Once configured, re-run your commit command:

```
git commit -m "Updated my website"
```

Step 5: Push Your Changes to the Cloud

Finally, send your local saved changes back up to the online repository.

1. Run the push command:

```
git push origin main
```

2. **Note for home users:** If prompted by a pop-up window, log into your GitHub account to authorize the upload.

Pro-Tips for Home Learners

- **Check your status:** Type **git status** at any time to see which files you changed and what Git is tracking.
- **Capitalization matters:** Git commands are entirely lowercase. Typing *Git Add* or *GIT PUSH* will result in an error.